

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



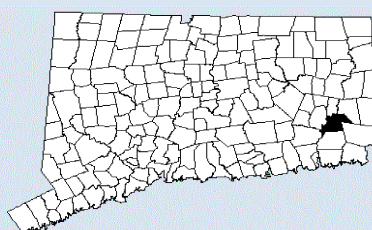
Preston School District

Roy Seitsinger Jr., Superintendent • 860-889-6098 • <http://www.prestonschools.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-8
Number of Schools/Programs	2
Enrollment	450
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$22,303
Total Expenditures ¹	\$14,095,602

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	221	49.1	48.3
Male	229	50.9	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	10	2.2	5.2
Black or African American	8	1.8	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	43	9.6	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	19	4.2	4.7
White	363	80.7	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	11	2.4	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	145	32.2	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	69	15.3	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	7	3.4	*	*
Male	15	7.1	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	0	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	*	*
White	20	6.0	9	2.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	0	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	9	7.3	9	5.3
Students with Disabilities	*	*	*	*
District	22	5.3	14	3.0
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 0

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	33.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	3.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	5.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	21.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	1.0
School Level	2.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	2.5
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	3.8
School Nurses	2.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	29.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.4
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1	2.0	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	48	98.0	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	9.8	13.3

Instruction and Resources

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	8	*
Emotional Disability	0	0
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	14	*
Other Health Impairment	25	78.1
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	7	*
District	56	67.5
State		66.8

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	16	2.7	2.6
Emotional Disability	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	16	2.7	6.4
Other Health Impairment	33	5.6	3.5
Other Disabilities	6	1.0	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	9	1.5	2.0
All Disabilities	87	14.7	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	26	29.9	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	7	8.0	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$7,528,016	\$11,911	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$2,431,691	\$5,577	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$352,061	\$807	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,140,791	\$2,616	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$475,123	\$1,090	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$222,983	\$511	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$954,468	\$2,189	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$990,469	\$1,517	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$14,095,602	\$22,303	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$884,541	21.7	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$616,007	15.1	10.2
Other Salaries	\$250,883	6.2	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$701,005	17.2	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$430,405	10.6	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$1,151,563	28.3	22.2
Supplies	\$18,685	0.5	0.7
Property Services	\$100	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$19,082	0.5	8.4
Equipment	\$3,667	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$4,075,937	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		28.9	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	72.8
State	21.8
Federal	4.6
Tuition & Other	0.8

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	6	*	6	*	*	*
Black or African American	6	*	6	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	29	68.8	29	63.0	8	*
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Two or More Races	10	*	10	*	*	*
White	201	70.8	201	64.1	72	70.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	11	*	11	*	6	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	244	70.0	244	63.3	87	70.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	87	67.8	87	60.4	37	69.5
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	168	71.6	168	65.8	56	72.6
Students with Disabilities	42	50.9	42	42.8	19	*
Students without Disabilities	213	74.1	213	68.1	74	75.7
High Needs	113	64.2	113	57.2	47	66.4
Non-High Needs	142	75.1	142	69.3	46	76.5
District	255	70.3	255	64.0	93	71.4

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	46.2	63.5	75.0	N/A	131	61.8
Curl Up	89.7	78.8	92.5	N/A	131	86.3
Push Up	59.0	51.0	67.5	N/A	130	58.5
Mile Run/PACER	62.2	62.7	72.5	N/A	128	65.6
All Tests - District	29.7	32.0	45.0	N/A	127	35.4
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	70.3	75	46.9	50	93.7	63.9
	High Needs Students	64.2	75	42.8	50	85.6	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	64.0	75	42.6	50	85.3	60.2
	High Needs Students	57.2	75	38.2	50	76.3	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	71.4	75	47.6	50	95.2	61.8
	High Needs Students	66.4	75	44.3	50	88.5	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	56.8%	100%	56.8	100	56.8	58.7%
	High Needs Students	53.8%	100%	53.8	100	53.8	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	56.6%	100%	56.6	100	56.6	61.4%
	High Needs Students	55.3%	100%	55.3	100	55.3	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	58.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	5.3%	<=5%	49.4	50	98.8	17.7%
	High Needs Students	6.9%	<=5%	46.3	50	92.5	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	.	.	.	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	.	75%	.	.	.	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		100.0%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		.	75%	.	.	.	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		95.5% 35.4%	75%	23.6	50	47.2	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		.	60%	.	.	.	55.0%
Accountability Index				654.2	900	72.7	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	64.2	10.8	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	69.3	57.2	12.1	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	66.4	8.6	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	100.0
	High Needs Students	100.0
Math	All Students	100.0
	High Needs Students	100.0
Science	All Students	100.0
	High Needs Students	100.0

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Preston Public Schools is committed to caring for students, families, and staff in the challenging times as we recover and re-engage from COVID-19 and always. We are dedicated to promoting the growth and development of all students. In recent years, the district has made significant progress in various policy redesigns, physical plant remodels, and technology purchases focused on improving student outcomes. Preston has established a five-year Evergreen Strategic Plan that is now up for review and places student well-being and academic success at the core of its work. The Strategic Plan is in the process of being modified to move Technology to a top priority, just below student wellness, and establish a new five-year plan by December 2023 in coordination with our joint town and district efforts. The district recognizes that with high-quality, fully integrated technology, the district can provide the necessary learning experience for teachers and the essential tools to teach our educators. Our new Technology Plan will also have to be modified as we adjust to the demands of providing full virtual instruction to all students. We have established an innovative partnership LEARN Collaborative to provide tech support five days a week.

Several student-oriented directives have been issued, and the district has embarked on an in-depth discussion about race, ethnicity, access, opportunity, equity, and a broad array of policies, procedures, and professional development tasks that emphasize the whole child have been acted on, voted in, or implemented. This work will continue for years to come. The Board of Education has established a policy and a communication committee to facilitate community engagement and share our success. Some of the next steps are the implementation of ClearGov financial software, the community facilities planning committee, the joint strategic planning team, and a multitude of grant opportunities.

Over the last school year, the disruption of COVID has lessened, and we have begun to focus on recovery. As we complete the FY22 year, we reinitiated our plans to encourage exemplary performances among students and staff. We offered after-school reading and mathematics programs for struggling learners who have been purposefully identified for that intervention. In addition, Preston Public Schools has actively embraced Scientifically Based Research Intervention and its behavioral counterpart, Positive Behavioral Support Intervention (PBIS), to create a positive atmosphere that encourages academic success. Our Emotional Learning strategy and our internal Social Emotional Equity Learning (SEEL) Team has been enhanced by a full-time social worker. We have also submitted a grant for the coming year that will add more social-worker time to our team.

The adoption of formative assessment programs such as Direct Reading Assessments, STAR Assessment, and Smarter Balanced Individual Assessment Blocks have all helped to create a data-based examination of how to assess student competency and develop appropriate instructional approaches in response to the results obtained from those assessments. As we complete this year, we have set a plan to assess our data trends and to use the trends to create intervention strategies. As part of our student-based analysis, we have also engaged in a national standards assessment of our early childhood program.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Preston Public Schools are embedded in a small, relatively homogenous community of approximately 4,800 people. The school district population PreK to 8 is comprised of about 450 students. Preston also cares for approximately 180 high school students that attend surrounding institutions. The district employs a variety of strategies that are designed to reduce racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. The COVID pandemic disrupted our efforts to examine race, access, and opportunity. However, we recently reactivated and reignited this work with an FY22 equity audit. We are engaged with the LEARN Collaborative and its offering: Race, Racism, Equity presentation by Dr. Lee Teitel. We use the Equity Tool Kit established by the Connecticut Department of Education for reference and guidance. We also made available Yale University's Center for Emotional Intelligence work, which includes Dr. Mark Brackett's offer for multiple virtual course offerings on various mental health issues. Recently, we have furthered our efforts by engaging Dr. Linda D'Arcy and Kevin Booker, Jr. to move our efforts forward.

We are in the process of reviewing our Strategic Plan to incorporate what we are learning into our future planning. A partnership has recently emerged with the town of Preston to create a cooperative strategic plan.

At the building levels, all students at the middle school level participate in an Advisor-Advisee program. This program provides a supervised venue for discussing various topics, including racial, ethnic, religious, and economic differences. We have an active Unity Club and we have reinitiated a student government and leadership team at the elementary and middle school levels.

At the PreK -5 level, much of our traditional activities were lost during the pandemic. The school's annual Preston Palooza and Thanksgiving Food Drive are events that engage virtually every student in appreciating the needs of those who are economically challenged and less fortunate. They did not occur due to COVID, but they were restarted this year to great success. There were no assemblies throughout the year.

We offered free meal picks for all students throughout the pandemic and we are advocates for continued free lunch in perpetuity.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Every effort is made to equalize the distribution of resources through the budgetary process and administrative protocols. Several budget process innovations include business case defense of innovation, “acceptable risk,” building-based budget allocation, and budget linkage to the strategic plan are being enhanced by the new ClearGov software. These processes help to assure equity in the distribution of resources. A collaborative approach to budget planning is required. It includes the entire leadership team, the building level administrators, the central office, union leadership, staff, and coordination with the First Selectwoman as a budget planning team member. Budgetary decisions are based on curriculum initiatives, safety and security priorities, mental health and wellness, and the overall needs of students.